

and thesaurus.

- ▶ **Spreadsheets:** Nothing new to report here. Spreadsheets is Kingsoft's spreadsheet program with which you can create invoices, budgets and other financial documents.
- ▶ **Presentations:** The presentation software of Kingsoft Office, Presentations, is easy to use. It contains plenty of themes, slides and presentations to choose from. You can also add pictures, graphics and animation to your slides.

If you require just the above software with no frills, then go for the free version. There's little difference between the free and Pro version, e.g. the presence of features such as online updating and macros in the latter.

SoftMaker Office Professional 2012

There are two editions of the SoftMaker's Office 2012 suite: SoftMaker Office Standard 2012 and SoftMaker Office Professional 2012. While the former includes 'TextMaker' (word processor), 'PlanMaker' (spreadsheets), 'Presentations' and 'BasicMaker' (a scripting engine), Office Professional throws in 'eM Client' (email client) and four basic Berlitz dictionaries into the bundle.

The SoftMaker Office Professional 2012 suite costs \$99.95 (Rs.6,025) and SoftMaker Office Standard 2012 costs \$79.95 (Rs.4,820) for three licenses. Here's a little bit about some of their main offerings.

- ▶ **TextMaker:** TextMaker has an old style interface, unlike the ribbon interface that other office suites are moving on to. TextMaker provides you with enough options for basic document creation and editing. Some useful features such as grammar check and track changes are missing from TextMaker, but it does give you the ability to insert comments.
- ▶ **PlanMaker:** PlanMaker should be enough to create invoices, budgets and other financial documents. It also provides you with some ready-to-use templates for different kinds of documents.
- ▶ **Presentations:** This presentation program should be sufficient to make everyday presentations. It has a large number of design templates and allows you to export presentations as video files. However, some important features – such as the ability to insert charts – are missing.
- ▶ **eM Client:** One good thing about SoftMaker Office is that it also comes with

